

Packing a Request & Printing the Pick List

Bed Ministry — Volunteer Instructions

Once a request is on the Waiting List, the next step is to gather (“pack”) the right beds and supplies for that family. The spreadsheet does the hard part for you: it figures out exactly what each child needs, prints a Pick List you can carry into storage, and sets aside those items so they aren’t promised to another family.

You do not need to do any math or know what’s in stock. Just tell the spreadsheet a few things about how you’re building the beds, and it does the rest.

Step 1 — Pick the request

- Open the Bed Requests spreadsheet and click the Waiting List tab along the bottom.
- Click anywhere in the row for the family you’re packing. (Each row is one request — you can recognize it by the tracking number in column B.)
- **Tip:** Only requests marked Active or Packed can have a pick list made. If you don’t see the request, it may have already been completed or cancelled.

Step 2 — Open the menu

At the top of the screen, click the **Bed Ministry** menu, then choose **Generate Pick List**.

A small window will open titled “Generate Pick List” with the tracking number. If you didn’t click a row first, it will ask you to type the row number — the number on the far left of the request’s row.

- **If you see “More children than beds”:** the request lists more children than there are sleeping spots (remember a bunk sleeps 2). You can choose Yes to continue if that’s correct, or No to go back and check the request.

Step 3 — Tell it how you’re building the beds

In the window, you’ll answer a few simple questions. Sensible answers are already filled in — you only change what you need to.

- **Each bed — Constructed or Purchased:** for every bed in the request, choose whether you’re using a frame our volunteers built (Constructed) or a store-bought one (Purchased). Cribs don’t have this choice.
- **Substitutions (optional):** if you need to, you can change the mattress thickness (6 inch or 8 inch) for a bed, or choose a comforter with or without a sheet set for a child. The window shows how many mattresses are on hand to help you decide.
- **Leaving something out (optional):** for extras — pillows, mattress protectors, bedrails, plaques, bears, and books — you can type a different number, including 0 if you’re not sending that item this time. Whatever number you enter is what gets recorded, so the inventory stays accurate.

- **Don't need to change anything?** That's normal — just leave the standard amounts as they are.

Step 4 — Generate and print the Pick List

- Click the button to generate the pick list.

A link will appear: **Open Pick List PDF**. Click it to open the printable pick list, then print it or save it.

The pick list groups everything by category and includes a parts checklist for any beds you're building from scratch. Carry it into storage and gather each item.

- **Saved automatically:** a copy is also saved in the "Pick Lists" folder in our Google Drive, so it's never lost.
- **Red warning on the pick list?** that means we're short on one or more items. You can still pack what we have — just let the ministry lead know what's short.

Step 5 — Mark the request "Packed"

This last step is important. It tells the spreadsheet to set those exact items aside for this family so they aren't counted as available for anyone else.

- Go back to the Waiting List tab.

In the **Status** column (column C) for that request, click the cell, then choose **Packed** from the drop-down.

That's it — the family's items are now reserved, and the request is ready for delivery.

If you need to change something later

If plans change before delivery, you can run Generate Pick List again on the same request. Your earlier choices will be filled back in so you can adjust them, and a fresh pick list will be made.